



Handicrafts Artisans in case of natural /accidental death or total/partial disability due to accident.

- The scheme is being implemented through the Life Insurance Corporation of India.
- The scheme covers artisans irrespective of gender, between the age group of 18-60 years.
- The annual premium under this component is Rs.200/-, of which Rs. 40/- is to be contributed by the artisan, Rs.60/- by the Government of India, and Rs.100/- by LIC.
- The insurance cover for natural death is Rs.30000/-; for death due to accident or permanent total disability due to accident is Rs.75000/- and Rs.37,500/- for partial disability due to accident.
- In addition, a scholarship of Rs.300/- per quarter per child for the education of two children from 9th to 12th Standard is also provided under the Shiksha Sahyog Yojana.

During the year 2007-08, 97,636 artisans have been covered and 5 lakh artisans are proposed to be covered during 11th five year plan. During 2008-09 the target is 1.00 lakh + 8.82 lakh artisans.

b) Rajiv Gandhi Shilpi Swasthya Bima Yojana – Launched in the last quarter of 2006-07 on a pilot basis to cover 50,000 artisan families.

In the approved scheme "Handicraft Artisans Comprehensive Welfare Scheme" for 11th Plan, the erstwhile two schemes have been merged and these now

constitute as two distinct components.

Brief features of the scheme are as under:

Rajiv Gandhi Shilpi Swasthya Bima Yojana

- The scheme aims at providing health and insurance cover to an artisan's family of four, including self, spouse and any three out of children, dependent parents.
- Medical cover – a package of Rs.15,000/- including Rs.7500/- for OPD, cashless facilities and pre-existing diseases as well.
- An insurance cover of Rs.1.00 lakh is also available for accidental death/disability of the insured artisan.
- Total Annual Premium is Rs.800/-
- A general category artisan contributes Rs.150/- and those belonging to SC/ST, BPL, NER communities contribute only Rs.75/-.

- The Government of India contributes the balance amount of Annual Premium as well as Service Tax at the applicable rates.

8.82 lakh artisanal families have been covered during 2007-08 and 40.40 lakh artisans are proposed to be covered during 11th five year plan. The scheme is being implemented by ICICI Lombard General Insurance Company.

Gandhi Shilp Bazaar

In order to provide marketing opportunity to handicrafts artisans in all parts of the country on continuous basis, series of Craft Bazaars under the name of "Gandhi Shilp Bazaar" has been launched in 2006 so that one craft bazaar is operational every day of the year.

Gandhi Shilp Bazaars are organised in metropolitan cities/state capitals or places of tourist/commercial interest with a view to provide direct marketing platform to the handicrafts artisans invited from various parts of the country. These Bazaars will continue to be organised through NGOs etc., in addition to a roster based Bazaar being organised at a prominent cities/historical places/ places of tourist interest to ensure that such bazaar are organised at least once a year on the same location at a fixed time. This will enable craft lovers of that area to source their requirement through these Craft Bazaars organised at a fixed venue and time.

